



SPN 1120C Beginning Spanish 1 80258

Classroom | Fall 2026

College of Arts & Sciences | English (Language & Literature)

Class Aug 17, 2026 - Nov 24, 2026 M W F -- 10:30 AM -- 11:45 AM -- Reed Hall
237

Exam Dec 02, 2026 - Dec 02, 2026 W -- 10:00 AM -- 12:15 PM -- Reed Hall 237

Instructor Information

Joyce LaOrden

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FGCU Rank: Instructor III

Degree/License: DML

Phone: 239 590 1453

Office Hours

by appointment

Office Location

Reed Hall 207C

Welcome Information

Spanish with Dr. Joyce LaOrden

- I am a very passionate person and Spanish fuels my passion.
- I am a lifelong learner.
- Join me on a journey using Spanish as our means of communicating.
- Interactive activities will keep you engaged.
- Low stake activities will provide constant feedback.
- I thank you for having a growth mindset, trusting the process and

believing in yourself.

Course Information

This is the first course in the first-year Spanish sequence and introduces students to the Spanish language. The topics included in the course are Spanish grammar, syntax, and vocabulary. Through the application of the grammar and vocabulary, students are introduced to some of the cultures and peoples of Spanish heritage, including figures from the Western canon. Not open to native or near-native speakers of Spanish.

Credit Hours: 4

No computers are allowed in class. You must have a copy of the book.

The library has a copy of the book. You can scan, send and print it.

Course Learning Outcomes

Students will demonstrate ability to communicate in the language to accomplish basic tasks.

Students will demonstrate ability to understand the cultural context of the language.

Students will produce simple texts.

Students will develop the skills of speaking, listening, reading, and writing to a beginning level of proficiency.

heas1 - identify how social or historical factors shape the ideas or emotions that people express or the objects they create.

heas4 - compare the ways in which people express complex ideas or emotions in a particular cultural, historical, or artistic environment.

A task-based (learn-by-doing), content-based Spanish learning course sequence

that encourages the integration of the four communication skills (listening, talking, reading and writing) and development of cultural awareness. Students learn Spanish in the classroom through interaction and collaborative work. In this course the students are active learners who negotiate and solve communication problems. Students also reflect upon how the language works and upon their own language learning process. Students prepare by acquiring vocabulary, structures, and interactional strategies that they will need to complete the task. By performing these various tasks, students are able to

FGCU First Day Ready

This course is part of our course material delivery program, FGCU First Day Ready. The bookstore will provide each student with a convenient package containing all required physical books and any digital materials will be integrated into Canvas for this course.

You should have received an email from the bookstore confirming materials provided for each of your courses and asking you to select how you would like to receive any printed components (in-store pick up or home delivery). If you haven't done so already, please confirm your fulfillment preference so the bookstore can prepare your materials.

For more information about First Day Ready, please go to <https://fgcu.edu/firstdayready>

To access your digital materials within Canvas:

Delivery Method	Direction
eBook	select the "Course Materials" link
Courseware - Single Sign On Partner Integration	select the "Course Materials" link
Courseware - Access Code Reveal	reveal the access code in the "Course Materials" link and redeem the code at the link provided on that page, or in the publisher's integration in Canvas
Courseware - Publisher Direct	select the publisher's link in your course

Required and/or Recommended Textbooks

1T CONNECT ONLINE ACCESS FOR EXPERIE

ISBN: 8220130683856

Authors: AMORES

Publisher: VST

Edition: 4TH 24

CLEARVUE 3-RING 1.5" BINDER

ISBN: 2818440008399

Authors: 695394535

Publisher: XX SUPPLY

Edition: Not Available

EXPERIENCE SPANISH (LOOSE)

ISBN: 9781266704284

Authors: AMORES

Publisher: MCG

Edition: 4TH 24

EXPERIENCE SPANISH (LOOSELEAF)-W/ACC

ISBN: 8220153931613

Authors: AMORES

Publisher: VST

Edition: 4TH 24

A Note on Materials

The materials below are subject to change.

Required and/or Recommended Course Materials

Experience Spanish 4e

ISBN: 9781264547593

Authors: Amores, Wendel, Suarez Garcia

Publisher: McGraw Hill

Publication Date: 2004

Edition: 4th

Final Exam

The final exam is comprehensive.

Grading Scale

GRADING SCALE

- A 100-90
- B+ 89-88
- B 87-80
- C+ 79-78
- C 77-70
- D 69-60
- F 59-0

Grade Categories and Weights

4 Chapter Exams 15%

Final exam 15%

Project 10%

Class work/ALA 20%

Class participation 20%

RVC 20%

100%

Assignment Descriptions

ALAs, RVCs, exit tickets.

Subject to Change

The assignments and assessments listed in the following components may be updated by due date, point value, etc. per the instructor's discretion. Notice will be posted to students if changes occur.

Schedule of Assignments

The assignments are in CANVAS.

Canvas Assignments

Due Date	Assignment Name	Type	Points
	ATTENDANCE QUIZ	Quiz	0
8/28/26	ALA # 1	Assignment	200
9/2/26	ABA # 1	Assignment	100
9/9/26	RVC # 1	Assignment	100
9/14/26	EXAM # 1	Assignment	152
9/25/26	ALA # 2	Assignment	200
9/30/26	ABA # 2	Assignment	100
10/5/26	RVC # 2	Assignment	100
10/12/26	EXAM # 2	Assignment	206
10/26/26	MEXICO: chapter # 3 p. 88	Assignment	100
10/28/26	ABA # 3	Assignment	100
11/2/26	ALA # 3	Assignment	200

Due Date	Assignment Name	Type	Points
11/2/26	RVC # 3	Assignment	100
11/4/26	EXAM # 3	Assignment	197
11/18/26	ABA # 4	Assignment	100
11/18/26	ALA # 4	Assignment	200
11/23/26	RVC # 4	Assignment	100

Late Submission and Make Up Policy

I do not accept LATE WORK.

Schedule of Course Activities

The course activities are in CANVAS.

General Education Information

This course is part of FGCU's General Education Program as approved by Florida's Board of Governors pursuant to Regulation 8.005. All required readings are intended to comply with all relevant statutes and regulations.

General Education is about embracing the joys of learning that will sustain you in your life and career. Each General Education course is an entry point for you to view the world through a different intellectual lens, expanding your understanding of the complexity of human experience and your role within a rapidly changing world. General Education encourages a spirit of inquiry and creativity that integrates knowledge and approaches from multiple fields to enrich students' academic lives, career trajectories, and personal growth. The skills that you will develop in these courses will allow you to become a more effective and

responsible writer, thinker, and citizen. The General Education experience will complement your major and prepare you to effect change in the world and adapt to the challenges of the future.

Attendance Policy

Class attendance is MANDATORY. Because this is a communication-focused course, you will not be able to achieve the course goals if you are not present in class. You may only miss three classes without penalty. Afterwards, for every class missed:

- I will deduct 3% off your final grade in CANVAS.
- If you miss seven classes, you will not pass this course.
- You will automatically receive a grade of F.

If you arrive late (not present when the class starts), you will be marked LATE. If you arrive 10 minutes after the class has started, you will be marked absent,

- For every two LATES I will deduct 1% off your final grade in CANVAS. If you leave class before a session ends without previous Instruction authorization, it will be an absence.

University Policies

FGCU has a set of central policies related to student recording class sessions, academic integrity and grievances, student accessibility services, academic disruption, and religious observances that apply to all courses at FGCU. Be sure to review these online at: <https://www.fgcu.edu/about/officeoftheprovoost/core-syllabus-policy-statements>